

Q What kind of engineering talent do you hire at NetApp?

We have a fairly big R&D set-up in India. We seek architects and engineers who are familiar with the IT environment across the region, and are conversant with the trends that drive industries like banking, telecom and manufacturing. We also keep in touch with how the government and its nodal agencies are connected with citizens and provide citizen services based on IT. We focus on service providers that capture the public cloud space, too. We look for talent that is conversant with the trends that drive businesses and therefore impact the kind of applications and workloads that, in turn, place certain requirements on the storage platform, which is basically the product portfolio that NetApp carries. On the other hand, there is the R&D department, which seeks talent that shapes product and technology directions. We have the largest technology centre across NetApp, globally, based here in India. Most of these engineers are engaged in actual product research and development.

So we look for talent across the programming and storage technologies and environments. Apart from this, we are fairly participative in the open source and open standards space, and obviously require talent that helps us contribute to the open source and open standards communities. That is the broad nature of engineering talent that we employ in our organisation.

Q What kind of open source technologies do you use and sell at NetApp?

The technologies that we use are a reflection of the kind of communities that we participate in and contribute to. For example, we contribute to the Linux kernel community. We have employees who have contributed directly to the Linux kernel. Another community that we work with very closely is FreeBSD. Other open source and open standards communities that we work with include the CDMI standard for data interoperability in the cloud environment. We support the standards in our products and technologies. For example, we have a product called Storage Grid, which provides a content repository that embraces all of the storage that exists globally in multiple data centres, into one single logical entity, which can be accessed from across the world. One of the standards that we use to allow consumers to access the data on this content repository is through the CDMI standard, which is popular and prevalent in the consumer cloud space. So we participate in the CDMI community, and incorporate support for CDMI products and technologies.

Yet another community that we work very closely with is OpenStack. It provides vendor agnostic standards and interfaces that allow us to build pooled infrastructure resources for private and public clouds. NetApp is one of the founding members of OpenStack. We contribute code to OpenStack releases. In the Folsom OpenStack release, we contributed code for the OpenStack compute and OpenStack Block Storage modules. We continue to work with OpenStack for its upcoming release, Grizzly, as well. We have proposed adding to the object base

“In our R&D environments, we look for the classical development skills around traditional languages like C/C++, Java and so on. In addition, we look for core operating system architectural skills, because the storage platform is a fairly comprehensive one that we have developed over the last 20 years into more or less a storage operating system.”

and block storage modules, extending them to incorporate support for file services in the OpenStack platform. There are engineers across our R&D department in India, and globally, who work vigorously in these communities, not only in terms of evangelising the standards and open source code, but also contributing to these in a major way. Some of these technologies are also used internally, not only to drive our innovation back into the community but also as part of the workplace resources that are required for our R&D environment.



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